

Informed Consent Form: Value-Driven Data Annotation Study

1. Introduction and Study Objectives

You are invited to participate in a research study titled **Value-Driven Data Annotation**. This project is conducted by researchers in the field of Natural Language Processing (NLP). The goal of this research is to understand how individuals' lived experiences and personal perspectives influence how they interpret and label subjectively sensitive data, such as online discussions about immigration or healthcare.

We challenge the idea that there is always a single "ground truth" for every piece of text. Instead, we believe that disagreement between people often reflects valuable differences in perspective rather than simple errors.

2. Procedures

If you agree to participate, you will complete the following steps:

1. **Background Information:** You will be asked to provide some basic background information regarding your connection to the study topics (e.g., immigration or chronic pain).
2. **AI-Guided Elicitation:** You will interact with a "Streamlit" AI interface. This interface will present a short scenario and ask you open-ended questions about your values, principles, and any life experiences that shape how you evaluate such situations. This process takes approximately 10–15 minutes and results in a "micronarrative" (a 200–300 word profile) of your perspective.
3. **Data Annotation:** You will be asked to label 30–40 short text items (sourced from platforms like Reddit or Twitter). For each item, you will provide a label, a brief 2–4 sentence explanation (rationale) for your choice, and rate your confidence in that label.
4. **Total Time:** The entire study is expected to take approximately 45–60 minutes.

3. Data Collection and Privacy

- **Types of Data:** We will collect your responses to the background questions, the transcript of your interaction with the AI, the generated micronarrative, your labels, and your written rationales.
- **Personally Identifiable Information (PII):** We do **not** collect your name, email address, or any direct identifiers. We use Prolific IDs to manage compensation, which are kept separate from your research data.

- **Storage:** All data will be stored on secure, encrypted servers. Only the immediate research team will have access to the full transcripts.
- **Anonymity:** When the results of this study are published, only aggregated data or anonymized, non-identifiable excerpts of rationales/narratives will be used.

4. Voluntary Participation and Withdrawal

Your participation is entirely voluntary. You may choose to skip any question you do not wish to answer. You may stop the study and withdraw your consent at any time by closing the browser window before submission without any penalty or loss of benefits to which you are otherwise entitled.

5. Risks and Benefits

- **Risks:** There are minimal risks associated with this study. Some text items or reflection questions may deal with sensitive topics (e.g., discrimination or medical dismissal). If you feel uncomfortable, you may stop at any time.
- **Benefits:** There are no direct benefits to you other than compensation. However, your participation helps improve how AI systems understand diverse human perspectives.

6. Compensation

You will be compensated at the rate advertised on the Prolific platform upon successful completion of the study tasks.

7. Contact Information

If you have any questions or concerns about this research, please contact the research team through the Prolific messaging system.

Consent Statement

By clicking "**I Agree**" below, you acknowledge that:

- You are at least 18 years of age.
- You have read and understood the information above.
- You voluntarily agree to participate in this study.
- You understand that you can withdraw at any time.

[**I Agree**] | [**I Do Not Agree**]

A PDF copy of this form is available for your records.